CrowPanelTelemetry - Documentation

Contents

Documentation: make the CrowPanel template your own **3**
Find what you need . . . 3
1. Before you begin . . . 3
Connect the panel and the three modules . . . 5
Compile the template: choose Arduino or PlatformIO . . . 10
2. How the program shares the work . . . 18
3. Your UI and application logic . . . 22
4. Measurements, files and connections . . . 26
5. Testing and troubleshooting . . . 30
Glossary . . . 33

Documentation: make the CrowPanel template your own

This guide helps you get the template running and understand where to make your changes. You do not need to know every chip or communication protocol before you begin. Start with a successful compile, change one small thing on the screen, and build your understanding from there.

The companion learning material contains the exercises, project worksheet and teacher notes. These are the two course documents. The repository also keeps wiring tables, test records and reviews for reference; you do not need to read all of them before your first lesson.

Find what you need

- Before you connect a board: identify the kit and prepare local settings.
- Connect the panel and modules: follow the connection tables and check the supply levels.
- Compile with Arduino IDE, Arduino CLI or PlatformIO: follow one complete route.
- How the program shares the work: understand the files and background jobs.
- Create your own screen and application: start with a small worked example.
- Measurements, images, sound and messages: find formats and expected behavior.
- Check your changes and solve problems: use evidence to narrow down a problem.
- Words you may not know yet: a short glossary.

If you only want to compile today, go straight to the build instructions. A board is not needed for that step. Before connecting or flashing classroom hardware, ask your teacher which checks have already been completed on your kit. The project's recorded tests do not yet demonstrate that every physical function works.

1. Before you begin

Your first goal is a build you can repeat. We call this your **baseline**: the unchanged starting program, together with the settings used to compile it. If a later change stops working, you can compare it with that known starting point.

1.1 Check what you have

You need the CrowPanel Advanced ESP32-P4 **10.1-inch V1.2**, the three specified modules, the intended power supply and a suitable data-capable UART0 USB cable. Confirm actual part and board revisions rather than relying on a similar product photograph. Several CrowPanel models use different processors, pins or displays.

Use the wiring guide as the connection reference. In particular:

- The INA226 uses the shared 3.3 V I2C connector J13.
- GPS reception uses J2 UART1 RX; the exact GT-U7 carrier's supply and TXD levels must be established before connection.
- The Core1262 uses the documented J7 SPI and control pins. Keep that routing.
- WiFi comes from the onboard C6. The upper-right extension socket is not needed for WiFi and is not the radio connection used by this template.

Before radio use, your teacher should check the antenna and the module's clock and antenna-switch connections. For measurements, use the approved low-voltage circuit and

load. A number that the program can display or send does not tell you how much voltage or current the physical module can safely handle.

An instructor should approve the physical setup and the intended RF exercise. Start with compilation and the host exercises while hardware checks are pending.

1.2 Keep the sketch together

Open the repository's `CrowPanelTelemetry.ino`. Arduino compiles the `.cpp` files beside it, so copying only the `.ino` is insufficient. Keep these files together:

```
CrowPanelTelemetry/
  CrowPanelTelemetry.ino
  App.h
  Config.h
  Application.cpp
  Workers.cpp
  Ui.cpp
  SdStorage.h
  Telemetry.h
  ttn-decoder.js
  patches/
  tools/
  tests/
```

The `.ino` delegates to `setupApplication()` and `loopApplication()`. Most student changes belong in `Ui.cpp` or `Application.cpp`, not in the entry sketch. The repository is the current template. The delivery ZIP in `artifacts/` is an older historical snapshot and does not include subsequent corrections.

1.3 Choose your local settings

`Config.h` is where you keep the hardware settings and device credentials. For your first compile, leave the supplied values alone. Before practical work, check the settings below with your teacher.

Setting	What you must establish
`DEV_EUI`, `JOIN_EUI`	The values belonging to your assigned device registration
`APP_KEY`, `NWK_KEY`	Both 16-byte root keys for LoRaWAN 1.1 OTAA
`INA_SHUNT_OHMS`	The actual fitted shunt resistance
`INA_MAX_CURRENT_A`	A calibration limit compatible with the shunt, wiring and PCB
`INA_ADDRESS`	The actual address straps, without a shared-bus conflict
`GPS_BAUD`	The configured NMEA baud rate of the module
`RADIO_TCXO_VOLTAGE`	The value justified by the fitted oscillator supply circuit
`AUDIO_FILE`	The selected WAV in the required simple format path on the SD card

Keep the existing pins. Use blank radio credentials for the initial offline build; the template then shows configuration status and does not start radio RF. Do not substitute dummy credentials into a board used for network tests. `INA_SHUNT_OHMS=0` deliberately leaves current/power uncalibrated. Voltage may appear locally, but protocol version 1 transmits an invalid triplet for that slot.

Store real credentials only in the instructor-approved local workflow. Do not put root keys or WiFi passwords in screenshots, shared submissions or a public Git history. The template's firmware/NVS storage is not encrypted.

1.4 Prepare files and try the board in stages

A FAT32 SD card should contain:

```
/images/001.jpg
/images/002.jpg
/audio/demo.wav
```

Use instructor-teacher-checked baseline JPEGs, preferably 600×270, and the exact WAV format explained in chapter 4. Do not use arbitrary web downloads as parser stress tests during initial bring-up.

After the hardware checklist permits operation, proceed in stages: display/touch, known DC sensor load, GPS, prepared SD/audio, C6 WiFi, and finally an approved LoRaWAN exercise. Check serial output alongside the panel. First sampling occurs after approximately one minute and a batch becomes available after ten slots. Neither WiFi nor TTN needs to be configured to study the UI and local data path. The C6 transport is nevertheless initialized by the baseline WiFi worker even when no WiFi credentials are entered.

If a stage fails, record the observed message and stop expanding the experiment. Use chapter 5 to isolate it. Repeated resets and repeated demo taps are not an appropriate way to accelerate public-network experiments: reset clears the volatile airtime deadline.

Connect the panel and the three modules

You will connect three small boards to the panel: the INA226 measures voltage, current and power; the GPS receiver reports a position; and the Core1262 sends LoRaWAN messages. The screen, touch controller, SD socket, audio circuit and WiFi chip are already on the panel. You do not have to wire those built-in parts again.

Take your time with the connectors. Two wires that fit mechanically are not necessarily an electrical match. Work with the power disconnected, identify the label at both ends, and ask a partner to check each connection before power-on. Use the tables below rather than guessing from the colors in a photograph.

The connection details below are taken from the project's V1.2 wiring reference. That reference and `Config.h` remain the places to check when a hardware detail changes. The pin numbers have not been changed for these student documents. Some details of the actual modules still need the checks clearly marked below.

A few labels to know

Label	What it means when you wire the kit
GND	The common electrical reference. The panel and modules need the specified ground connections.
3V3	A 3.3 V supply. It is not interchangeable with 5 V.
GPIO	A numbered processor signal. Its job here is set by the software and wiring.
J7.9	Connector J7, contact 9. This is different from GPIO9.

Label	What it means when you wire the kit
TX / RX	Serial transmit / receive. GPS TXD connects to the panel's RX input.
SDA / SCL	The two shared I2C signal wires. Match SDA to SDA and SCL to SCL.
IN+ / IN−	The current-measurement path through the INA226 shunt, not its logic-power pins.

Use the rear view to find the connectors

Read the panel from the back, upright as shown in the image. The board numbers and connector positions matter; looking into the cable plug reverses the view. J13 is the sensor connector, J2 is the GPS serial connector, and J7 is the chosen radio connector. The upper-right wireless extension socket is not used for this radio connection. WiFi comes from the onboard ESP32-C6.

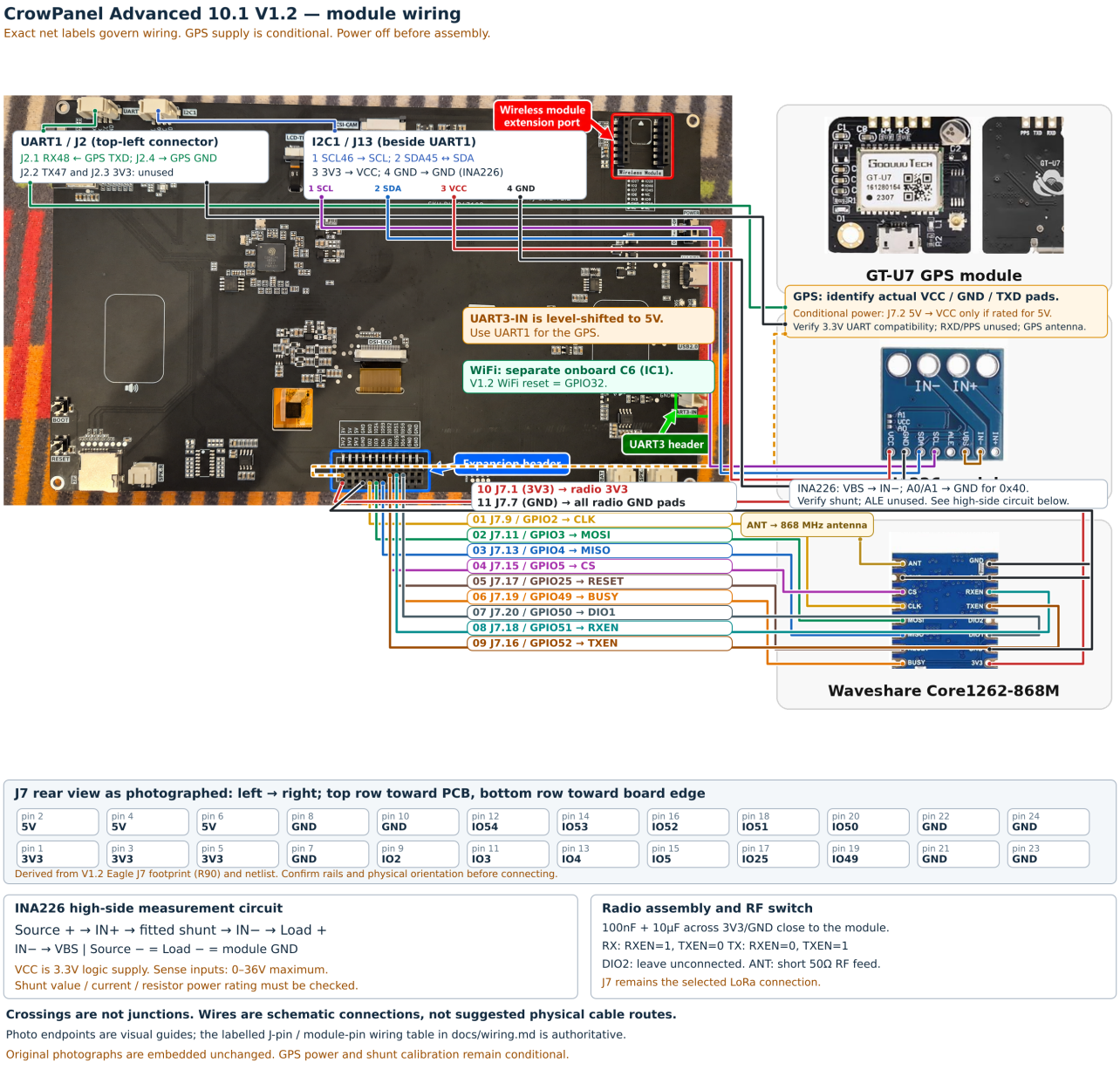


Figure 1: Panel and module wiring overview. Use the tables for exact contacts and conditional GPS power.

The picture is an overview. Zoom the original image or vector version when you need to read a small label. For the radio, **DIO1 goes to J7.20 / GPIO50; DIO2 stays unconnected**. Use the table when a line in the photograph is hard to follow. GPS power stays disconnected until the rating of your particular breakout is confirmed.

The LoRa radio: Core1262-868M / SX1262

WiFi comes from the separate onboard ESP32-C6 (IC1). The upper-right wireless extension socket is not required for WiFi. The external Core1262 remains on J7 for this template; no socket adapter or pin reassignment is used.

Panel contact	P4 GPIO / net	Radio pad	Direction at P4
J7.9	GPIO2	CLK	Output, SPI clock
J7.11	GPIO3	MOSI	Output, SPI data
J7.13	GPIO4	MISO	Input, SPI data
J7.15	GPIO5	CS	Output, active low
J7.17	GPIO25	RESET	Output, active low
J7.19	GPIO49	BUSY	Input
J7.20	GPIO50	DIO1	Input, interrupt-capable
J7.18	GPIO51	RXEN	Output, RF switch receive control
J7.16	GPIO52	TXEN	Output, RF switch transmit control
J7.1	3.3V	3V3	Power
J7.7	GND	All exposed GND pads	Common ground / RF return
No P4 contact	—	DIO2	Leave unconnected
No P4 contact	—	ANT	868MHz antenna via short 50Ω RF feed

Fit 100nF ceramic and about 10µF bulk decoupling close to the radio supply. Use a suitable carrier for the castellated module, short digital wires, and a short ground return. Do not run ANT along a breadboard jumper: use a proper antenna connector/coax and ground layout. Attach the antenna before transmitting. Radio initialization requests14dBm; LoRaWAN/ADR subsequently controls power up to a RadioLib request of 16dBm conducted power at TXPower 0. The regional parameter default is 16dBm EIRP, not conducted power. In 868.0–868.6MHz the 25mW ERP limit is about 13.98dBm ERP / 16.13dBm EIRP. Include antenna gain and cable loss: EIRP = conducted dBm + gain dBi − loss dB; ERP = EIRP − 2.15dB. See the component sources. Measure under separately authorized RF testing before operation; no antenna gain, power cap or compliance is assumed.

RXEN and TXEN are **separate switch inputs**. RX uses RXEN=1/TXEN=0; TX uses RXEN=0/TXEN=1; idle uses both low. RadioLib controls them through `setRfSwitchPins()`, and its automatic DIO2 switch output is disabled. The English Waveshare wiki reverses the RX/TX sentence; its Chinese documentation and the RF paths on the schematic establish the mapping above. Do not short DIO2 to RXEN.

The published module schematic shows TCXO power from 3V3 through R22, with an alternative DIO3 ferrite path. The default `RADIO_TCXO_VOLTAGE=0.0f` disables DIO3 supply control for the fixed-supply arrangement. **Population of R22/FB1 on your actual module is not established by the photograph.** Confirm it before RF bring-up. If only DIO3 supplies the oscillator, obtain its rated voltage and set that exact value; do not guess 1.8V or 3.3V. DIO3 needs no external P4 wire.

INA226 external I2C1 connector J13

J13 sits immediately beside UART1 at the top left. Its contact order, viewed from the same rear board view, left → right, is **SCL, SDA, 3V3, GND**. Cable mating views mirror this order; confirm the housing's pin 1 rather than copying a cable photo. Shared I2C includes the on-board touch controller and audio codec.

Panel contact	Signal	INA226 pad
J13.1	SCL / GPIO46	SCL
J13.2	SDA / GPIO45	SDA
J13.3	3.3V	VCC
J13.4	GND	GND
GND	Address strap	A0 and A1, for 0x40
No connection	Alert output	ALE
Load-side IN−	Bus sense	VBS

Inspect existing A0/A1 straps before adding jumpers. Do not short a strap already connected to another rail. Default software address is 0x40; change `INA_ADDRESS` if the actual module uses another non-conflicting address. The ES8311 uses 0x18; touch is normally 0x5D (0x14 is also supported). Start I2C at 100kHz. Existing pull-ups may suffice; measure bus rise time if long wiring causes errors. All external pull-ups must go to 3.3V. Do not power this breakout from 5V.

Connect the measured circuit as:

```
source + ---- IN+ ---- fitted shunt ---- IN− ---- load +
                                          |
                                         VBS
source − ------------------------------------ load −
   |
panel/module GND
```

The chip's sensing range is 0–36V and shunt differential range is approximately ±81.92mV. These are chip limits, **not a current rating for the photographed PCB**. Confirm whether a shunt is installed and its resistance/power rating, then respect $I \times R < 81.9\text{mV}$ and $I^2 \times R$ heating plus connector/trace ratings. For example, R100=0.1Ω with the default 0.8A calibration gives 80mV and 0.064W in the shunt; that example is not identification of your board's resistor.

The photo does not establish the shunt value. `INA_SHUNT_OHMS=0` intentionally keeps current/power unavailable until you enter the real value. Uncalibrated batches are marked invalid; measured voltage can still appear on screen. Power sent to TTN is the INA226 power register, not a second U×I calculation. Power is represented as the monitor's unsigned register output; signed current is preserved. This template targets a DC source/load measurement, not AC/mains.

GT-U7 GPS and UART1 J2

J2 is the top-left UART1 connector, **not the right-side UART3-IN**. From the rear board view, left → right: **RX48, TX47, 3V3, GND**.

Panel contact	GPS pad	Status
J2.1 RX / GPIO48	TXD	Only after confirming TXD is 3.3V-compatible UART
J2.4 GND	GND	Common ground
J7.2 5V	VCC	**Conditional: connect only if this exact breakout accepts 5V**
Unused	RXD	Not needed for NMEA reception
Unused	PPS	Not needed
Unused J2.2 / J2.3	—	No wire

The photograph identifies a GT-U7 family board but not a manufacturer-backed schematic for its regulator, VCC rating, or UART level. Therefore the GPS power connection is **not verified for your exact module**. Obtain the seller's exact specification or inspect its regulator/board first. If it needs regulated 3.3V, use the documented 3.3V rail instead; do not feed 5V into a bare 3.3V GPS supply. Do not connect its USB supply simultaneously without verifying the board's power path. If TXD is 5V or1.8V, use an appropriate UART level translator to3.3V first; a merely lower-than3.3V high level is not sufficient to guarantee input recognition.

Use 9600 baud NMEA initially; change `GPS_BAUD` if its configured rate differs. Attach its appropriate GPS antenna and place it with a clear sky view. No GPS RX wire is needed, so the P4 cannot accidentally reconfigure it.

UART3-IN J10 has 5V-level translation on TX/RX and its VCC is a **power input**. It is unsuitable as a guessed 3.3V GPS connector or as a GPS power output.

Complete J7 orientation

The Eagle J7 package is 2×12, rotation R90. As seen in the supplied upright rear photo, columns run left → right; the even row is toward the board interior and the odd row toward the lower board edge.

Column	Top / even contact	Net	Bottom / odd contact	Net
1	2	5V	1	3V3
2	4	5V	3	3V3
3	6	5V	5	3V3
4	8	GND	7	GND
5	10	GND	9	GPIO2
6	12	GPIO54	11	GPIO3
7	14	GPIO53	13	GPIO4
8	16	GPIO52	15	GPIO5
9	18	GPIO51	17	GPIO25
10	20	GPIO50	19	GPIO49
11	22	GND	21	GND
12	24	GND	23	GND

Built-in peripherals retained

Function	V1.2 assignment / ownership
LCD	Two-lane MIPI DSI; reset41, backlight31, power29 active low
GT911	I2C45/46, reset40, interrupt42; polling ready flag
C6 WiFi	SDIO clock18, CMD19, D0=17, D1=16, D2=15, D3=14, reset32
SD card	SDMMC slot0 / one-bit CLK43, CMD44, D0=39
Audio	ES8311 I2C0x18; I2S BCLK22, LRCLK21, data23, MCLK24; amp30
GPS	UART1 RX48; TX47 unused
INA226	Shared I2C45/46, default address0x40
LoRa	Dedicated SPI GPIO matrix mapping on J7, separate from onboard C6

On-board microphones, CSI camera, USB host, battery charging telemetry and the alternative unpopulated NS4168 circuit are outside the requested template scope.

Power budget

Use the panel's intended regulated5V input and its manufacturer-rated supply/cable; the documented UART3-IN input rating is5V±5%, up to2A. Expansion5V/3V3 contacts are supply rails, not arbitrarily interchangeable power inputs. The external I2C and UART1 ports are specified as3.3V. Confirm total available rail current with the panel/backlight/WiFi/audio active, rather than treating a connector rating as free headroom after all on-board loads.

Waveshare lists approximately45mA TX at14dBm and5.3mA receive; the LoRaWAN stack can request higher power, so do not size the supply to that typical TX value alone. INA226 itself draws about330µA typical; breakout LEDs/pull-ups can add current. The exact GT-U7 breakout's current demand remains unverified. During hardware testing, check3.3V at the radio and5V at the panel during simultaneous audio/WiFi/RF.

Check together before switching on

1. With power off, let one person read each table row while the other follows the actual wire. Confirm the connector contact, signal and module pad.
2. Check common ground and supply rails. Keep 5 V away from 3.3 V signal pins.
3. Confirm the GPS supply and serial levels, the INA226 shunt/address and the radio oscillator supply with your teacher. Do not fill in unknown values by guessing from a similar board on the internet.
4. Keep the DC experiment within the approved voltage/current range. Connect the radio's antenna before any separately approved radio test.
5. Record what was checked in the worksheet. A passed compile does not check wiring; a photograph does not establish the rating of a fitted part.

For powered checks and later tests, use the hardware checklist with your teacher. Stop and disconnect power if a supply voltage is wrong or a component becomes unexpectedly warm.

Compile the template: choose Arduino or PlatformIO

Use this guide before changing the UI or application logic. Your first milestone is to compile the supplied template with blank radio credentials and record how you did it. You do not

need a connected panel, SD card, GPS fix or TTN account to complete that milestone.

All three routes build the same application. Choose one for your first build; you do not have to install and learn all three. You can change tools later without moving the firmware into a different project.

Route	Choose it when	What you use
Arduino IDE	You prefer menus, an editor and a Verify button	Arduino IDE with Espressif's pinned board package
Arduino CLI	You want repeatable terminal commands and saved logs	Arduino CLI 1.5.1; optionally the repository Makefile
PlatformIO	You prefer PlatformIO or VS Code	Core 6.2.0 and the repository's pinned `platformio.ini`

You are in the documentation. Work through the route you choose, then return to the first exercise in the learning material. The build settings live in the repository configuration files; the commands here show you how to use them.

1. Prepare the source and your build record

Get the current course repository from your instructor. Keep the whole `CrowPanelTelemetry` folder, including the root `.ino`, `.cpp` and `.h` files, `patches/` and `tools/`. Copying only the `.ino` leaves out the application. Do not start from the historical ZIP in `artifacts/`.

Open a terminal in the repository root: the directory containing `CrowPanelTelemetry.ino`, `Makefile` and `platformio.ini`. All commands below start there. Paths beginning with `/absolute/path/` are placeholders you must replace; put quotes around your real paths, especially if they contain spaces.

The terminal examples use Bash on Linux/macOS. On Windows, the Arduino IDE route uses the same board settings, but terminal commands need an appropriate shell and installed tools. PowerShell environment-variable examples are given where useful; the recorded build validation was performed on Linux.

Start section 2 of your worksheet. Record the assigned source revision. In a Git checkout, these read-only commands help identify it and any local changes:

```
git rev-parse HEAD
git status --short
```

Leave the delivered radio credentials blank for the first compile. Leave pin assignments unchanged. `INA_SHUNT_OHMS=0` is the deliberate uncalibrated starting configuration; it is sufficient for compilation. Hardware calibration comes later.

2. Prepare one shared library collection

Ask the instructor for the exact dependency collection, or obtain the complete release sources using the pinned release links. Do not select a newer release just because a package manager offers it.

A convenient layout supports all three routes:

```
course-sketchbook/
  libraries/
    Arduino_GFX/library.properties
    RadioLib/library.properties
    INA226/library.properties
    TinyGPSPlus/library.properties
    JPEGDEC/library.properties
    audio-driver/library.properties
```

Each listed folder must contain the complete library, including its source files. `library.properties` must be directly inside the named folder, rather than inside another release-named subdirectory. The project itself stays in its existing repository directory, outside this collection.

Folder	Required release	Extra preparation
`Arduino_GFX`	1.6.9	None
`RadioLib`	7.8.1	Apply the current project patch
`INA226`	0.6.6	None
`TinyGPSPlus`	v1.0.3a	None
`JPEGDEC`	1.8.4	Apply the current project patch
`audio-driver`	0.3.1	None

Some upstream metadata is stale: the exact JPEGDEC 1.8.4 sources report 1.2.7, and TinyGPSPlus v1.0.3a reports 1.0.3. Record the release source as well as the build's displayed version. Do not edit library metadata to hide the difference. Wire, SPI, WiFi, Preferences and ESP_I2S come with the Arduino core. You do not need LVGL or a collection copied from a CrowPanel demo.

Set DEPS to the absolute path of the **libraries directory**, not its parent:

```
export DEPS="/absolute/path/to/course-sketchbook/libraries"
python3 tools/patch_dependency.py radiolib-7.8.1 "$DEPS/RadioLib"
python3 tools/patch_dependency.py jpegdec-1.8.4 "$DEPS/JPEGDEC"
```

You need Python 3 and the standard `patch` executable for this step. In PowerShell, the corresponding variable and patch commands are:

```
$env:DEPS = 'C:/absolute/path/to/course-sketchbook/libraries'
python tools/patch_dependency.py radiolib-7.8.1 "$env:DEPS/RadioLib"
python tools/patch_dependency.py jpegdec-1.8.4 "$env:DEPS/JPEGDEC"
```

Checkpoint: both commands must finish successfully. They check exact source hashes and also accept an already correctly patched library. If a command refuses the source, check the selected release and whether an older patch was applied. Obtain clean sources of the required release instead of bypassing the checks. A successful compile alone does not prove that JPEGDEC is patched.

Use these same physical folders for every build route. This avoids fixing a library in one location while compiling another copy elsewhere.

3. Identify the board configuration

Ask the instructor which P4 silicon revision is fitted. The panel PCB's V1.2 label is not the chip revision.

Actual P4 silicon	Arduino Chip Variant	CLI option	PlatformIO environment	CPU
Before v3.00	Before v3.00	`prev3`	`crowpanel-prev3`	360 MHz
v3.00 or newer	v3.00 or newer	`postv3`	`crowpanel-postv3`	400 MHz

Both use 16 MB flash, PSRAM enabled, QIO flash at 80 MHz and the `app3M_fat9M_16MB` partition. That partition reserves about 3 MB for the application and an internal FAT area; it does not format or replace the removable SD card. Use UART0 for the initial serial/upload workflow, USB CDC on boot disabled and 115200 baud for the serial monitor. Keep erase-all-flash disabled.

If the actual silicon is not yet known, record that uncertainty. A compile for one target is useful evidence, but it is not enough to select firmware to flash.

Route A: Arduino IDE

A1. Install or select the board package Use the instructor's Arduino IDE installation, or follow the official IDE installation guide. Record your IDE version; the repository's automated Arduino evidence uses CLI 1.5.1 rather than an automated test of the IDE's graphical interface.

1. Open Preferences (called Settings in some desktop versions).
2. Add the following Additional Boards Manager URL, retaining any other URLs required by your course:

   ```
   https://espressif.github.io/arduino-esp32/package_esp32_index.json
   ```

3. Open **Tools → Board → Boards Manager**, search for esp32, and locate **esp32 by Espressif Systems**.
4. Select **3.3.12** explicitly and install that version if it is not already available. It supplies the matching ESP-IDF 5.5.5 components. Do not accept an automatic upgrade for this exercise.

Arduino describes package selection in its Boards Manager instructions. Changes on managed classroom computers should be arranged with the instructor.

A2. Point the IDE at the prepared libraries In Preferences, set Sketchbook location to the `course-sketchbook` directory from section 2. Its `libraries/` subdirectory is your DEPS. Restart the IDE if needed for library discovery. This changes where the IDE looks for user libraries; it does not require moving the template into that sketchbook.

Open **File → Open** and select the existing `CrowPanelTelemetry.ino`. Check that the application `.cpp` and `.h` files remain beside it. Do not create an empty sketch and paste only the `.ino` contents into it.

A3. Set the target and compile Select **Tools → Board → esp32 → ESP32P4 Dev Module**, then check the Tools menu:

Setting	Value
Chip Variant	The actual silicon choice from section 3

Setting	Value
CPU frequency	Selected by Chip Variant: 360 MHz for `prev3`, 400 MHz for `postv3`
Flash Size	16 MB
PSRAM	Enabled
Flash Mode / Flash Frequency	QIO / 80 MHz
Partition Scheme	16M Flash (3MB APP/9.9MB FATFS)
USB Mode	USB-OTG (TinyUSB), the default mode value 0
USB CDC On Boot	Disabled
Erase All Flash Before Sketch Upload	Disabled
Upload Speed	115200

USB Mode names the native USB configuration; it does not select the physical UART0 connector. Keep CDC on boot disabled for this baseline. Menu wording can differ by IDE version; the package must still be 3.3.12. Enable verbose output during **compilation** in Preferences so you can inspect library selection. Click the **Verify** checkmark, rather than Upload. A serial port and connected board are not needed for Verify.

A4. Check and save the result Wait for the entire build to finish. Save the output showing successful completion, flash/RAM usage and selected library paths. Check that the external libraries come from your prepared collection. If the IDE reports multiple candidates, use the path it actually selected to determine whether the correct source was built.

Record the Tools settings and IDE version in your worksheet. A Verify result shows that a firmware image can be built; it does not demonstrate display, touch, WiFi, GPS, sensor, audio or radio operation. Continue with section 4 below.

Route B: Arduino CLI

B1. Check the tools and installed core Use the instructor-provided **Arduino CLI 1.5.1**, or obtain that exact version using the official CLI installation options. Put its executable on your shell's PATH, then check:

```
arduino-cli version
arduino-cli core list
```

The version must be 1.5.1 and the installed Espressif core must include `esp32:esp32` **3.3.12**. If the core is missing, use the board-package preparation from route A or ask the instructor to prepare the CLI's own configured data directory. Different CLI/IDE configurations can point at different installations; the `core list` from the CLI you will compile with is the relevant check.

B2. Build using the repository Makefile With `DEPS` still set, run the following if your computer has `make`. Use a repository/build path without spaces for this route: the existing Makefile does not quote every generated-directory argument. The direct CLI alternative below quotes its paths.

```
make compile \
  ARDUINO_CLI=arduino-cli \
  LIBRARIES="$DEPS" \
  BUILD="$PWD/build/codex/student-baseline" \
  FQBN='esp32:esp32:esp32p4:FlashSize=16M,PSRAM=enabled,PartitionScheme=app3M_fat9M_16MB,ChipVariant=
↪  prev3'
```

Replace only `ChipVariant=prev3` with `ChipVariant=postv3` for newer silicon. If the CLI is not on PATH, replace `ARDUINO_CLI=arduino-cli` with `ARDUINO_CLI="/absolute/path/to/arduino-cli"`.

FQBN identifies the board package, board and menu options. `LIBRARIES` directs library discovery to the prepared collection. `BUILD` keeps generated output, cache and temporary files under the ignored `build/codex/` directory. The target compiles without uploading.

B3. Or call the CLI directly This Bash equivalent does not require `make`. Its verbose output is useful when checking dependency selection. Use this instead of B2, not as a required second build:

```
mkdir -p build/codex/student-cli/tmp build/codex/student-cli/cache
TMPDIR="$PWD/build/codex/student-cli/tmp" \
ARDUINO_BUILD_CACHE_PATH="$PWD/build/codex/student-cli/cache" \
arduino-cli compile --verbose \
  --fqbn 'esp32:esp32:esp32p4:FlashSize=16M,PSRAM=enabled,PartitionScheme=app3M_fat9M_16MB,ChipVarian
  ↪  t=prev3' \
  --libraries "$DEPS" \
  --build-path "$PWD/build/codex/student-cli/output" \
  .
```

The final `.` means the existing sketch in the current directory. Again, change the Chip Variant for newer silicon. Save the complete successful output and memory summary. Inspect the Used library paths, not only the displayed metadata version. Continue with section 4.

Route C: PlatformIO

C1. Use the existing project configuration Open the repository containing `platformio.ini`. Do not create a new PlatformIO project, move files into `src/`, or copy the firmware. The configuration already selects pioarduino **55.03.312**, Arduino core **3.3.12**, the partition and both P4 environments. Its local-library references use your DEPS collection.

Use **PlatformIO Core 6.2.0**, pinned in `requirements-platformio.txt`. If the instructor has already provided it, check `pio --version` and go to C2. Otherwise, these Bash commands prepare an isolated Core inside the ignored build directory:

```
python3 -m venv build/codex/platformio-cli
build/codex/platformio-cli/bin/python -m pip install -r requirements-platformio.txt
export PATH="$PWD/build/codex/platformio-cli/bin:$PATH"
pio --version
```

This requires Python's virtual-environment support and network access for package downloads. Windows virtual environments use `Scripts` instead of `bin`. An older Core is not a compatible substitute for this pinned platform.

C2. Compile from the terminal Set DEPS in the terminal that will run the build. Choose **one** command matching the silicon:

```
pio run -e crowpanel-prev3
```

```
pio run -e crowpanel-postv3
```

The first build downloads the pinned platform, framework and compiler packages. Allow several gigabytes of disk space and enough time for those downloads. Packages go into `build/codex/platformio-core/`; workspace files go into `build/codex/platformio/`. They do not replace your Arduino installation.

Wait for the final **SUCCESS** result, not just compilation of the last source file. Save the dependency graph and flash/RAM summary. The `symlink://` libraries must resolve to the prepared DEPS folders.

Use ordinary `pio run`, **without `-v`**: the pinned Core/framework combination has a known verbose-mode logging failure during binary generation. An ELF left behind by a failed command is not a completed successful build. For additional configuration information, use:

```
pio project metadata -e crowpanel-prev3 --json-output
```

Substitute the newer environment when appropriate. If you need a clean rebuild, use `pio run -e crowpanel-prev3 -t clean` for that environment, then build again. Do not delete the prepared libraries as part of cleaning outputs.

C3. Optional: use VS Code's PlatformIO extension

1. Install or open the instructor-provided PlatformIO IDE extension.
2. Launch VS Code with this repository as the open folder. Make sure its process receives DEPS; with the `code` command available, run `code .` from the prepared terminal. An editor that was already running may need to be closed and relaunched to inherit the variable.
3. In the extension settings, disable `platformio-ide.useBuiltinPIOCore` and set `platformio-ide.customPATH` to the directory containing the selected 6.2.0 `pio` executable. For the local example, that is the absolute path to `build/codex/platformio-cli/bin`.
4. Confirm `pio --version` and DEPS in the PlatformIO terminal. Check the Build task's resolved library paths as well; a terminal variable alone does not prove that a previously started editor inherited it.
5. In Project Tasks, select `crowpanel-prev3` or `crowpanel-postv3` and **Build**. Avoid Upload for the compile-only baseline.

The recorded validation covers the command-line builds. The extension's graphical workflow has not been physically or interactively verified in this project.

4. Finish the baseline and continue the lesson

Complete this checklist regardless of your selected route:

- ☐ Source revision and local changes recorded.
- ☐ Exact library releases obtained; both patch checks passed.
- ☐ Selected library paths point to the prepared collection.
- ☐ Core 3.3.12 and the intended silicon/partition configuration confirmed.
- ☐ Full build completed successfully; exact command or IDE settings saved.
- ☐ Flash and static-RAM usage recorded, with the complete build log.
- ☐ Blank radio credentials retained for the offline baseline.

- [ ] Compile evidence labelled separately from hardware evidence.

Once your baseline record is complete, continue with Lesson 1 in the learning material. After each small change, compile again and compare the result with your starting build.

Your teacher may also ask you to run checks on your computer. Follow the host-check instructions later in this document. Those checks do not emulate the ESP32. PlatformIO's `pio test` is not the test command configured for this project. If a required tool is missing, record that rather than marking the check as passed.

5. Switch tools without changing the application

Keep the same source, `Config.h`, dependency folders and patches when switching between Arduino and PlatformIO. Use **one active builder at a time** in this checkout. PlatformIO temporarily creates `CrowPanelTelemetry.ino.cpp` beside the sketch and normally removes it on exit. An interrupted build can leave it behind; after confirming no builder is running, remove only that generated intermediate before an Arduino build. Do not edit or submit it as application source.

Uploading either workflow's output replaces the firmware on the panel. Two build routes do not create two independently running applications. Binary sizes can differ between build systems even when source and relevant configuration match; record which workflow produced each result.

6. If compilation fails

Symptom	Check first	Useful next action
A header cannot be found	Complete source/library layout and DEPS	Check `library.properties` is directly under each named folder and inspect selected paths
Patch tool refuses the source	Exact tag, old patch or locally modified vendor file	Preserve your work and obtain a clean copy of the pinned release
Radio callback/API is missing	Stock or wrong RadioLib selected	Recheck the current patch and actual compiler-selected library path
P4 board or Chip Variant is missing	Wrong Arduino core or PlatformIO platform	Compare with the pinned versions, not a generic ESP32 setup tutorial
PlatformIO cannot resolve a library link	DEPS in the build process environment	Set its absolute path and relaunch the editor if necessary
PlatformIO fails in binary-generation logging	Use of `-v` with the pinned stack	Run the documented ordinary build; retain any other error for diagnosis
Duplicate sketch definitions after switching tools	Leftover generated `.ino.cpp`	Stop builders, identify the intermediate and remove only that generated file
Build succeeded, but a device function fails	Compile evidence cannot establish physical operation	Use the hardware checklist and serial diagnosis with your instructor

Bring the **first meaningful error**, complete build log, selected versions and exact command/settings to a help session. Do not change several library versions at once; that destroys the reproducible baseline you need for diagnosis.

Flashing is a separate practical step. Use the hardware checklist and the bring-up reference with your instructor. RF testing requires its own approved setup; a compile-only exercise does not require an upload or network join.

2. How the program shares the work

Think of the program as a small team. One part looks after the screen, another handles files, and another talks to the radio. Each part has a clear job. In this guide, we call that responsibility **ownership**. For example, pressing Play asks the sound-handling code to do some work; the button itself does not read and play the whole file. This keeps the screen available for the next tap.

2.1 Where to find the code you want to change

File	Responsibility	Typical student change
`CrowPanelTelemetry.ino`	Delegates Arduino setup/loop to the application	Usually none
`Config.h`	Pin and credential configuration	Assigned credentials, verified calibration, application configuration
`App.h`	Shared model, command/event types and public interfaces	A genuinely new piece of application state or message contract
`Application.cpp`	UI model, GPS parsing, sample scheduler, live sensor I2C and event handling	Application rules, derived state, integration of results
`Ui.cpp`	Display drawing, screen navigation, touch decoding, button actions	Your interface, layout, labels and interaction flow
`Workers.cpp`	Radio/NVS, WiFi, media and audio workers	A change to a worker's actual responsibility, when required
`SdStorage.h`	Slot-0 lifecycle used by the media worker	Normally unchanged
`Telemetry.h`	Reading/batch types, binary encoder and pacing decisions	Only a deliberate data/protocol change
`ttn-decoder.js`	Matching network-side decoder	Must change together with a changed message format

`AGENTS.md` records the ownership/build contract. Consult it before changing a boundary. A helper file is not a reason to add a second implementation of the same rule or a second owner for a peripheral.

2.2 What happens when the program starts

`setupApplication()` begins by putting the amplifier into shutdown, starts serial logging, then initializes Wire on GPIO45/46. Sensor discovery and ES8311 setup run before worker tasks start. A temporary I2S clock is used during codec setup. GPS UART reception and the display/touch setup follow.

`startWorkers()` creates queues, then radio, WiFi and audio tasks. The WiFi task starts the media task after `WiFi.mode()` returns. This orders the application's initialization calls; it does **not** serialize SDMMC traffic with Hosted traffic.

Finally, the application schedules the first sample for one minute later. The UI model is initialized before normal touch processing. Some display-driver failures abort inside the dependency, so the program may panic/reboot before worker startup; there is no guaranteed on-screen error page for that failure.

2.3 Follow a reading or a button press

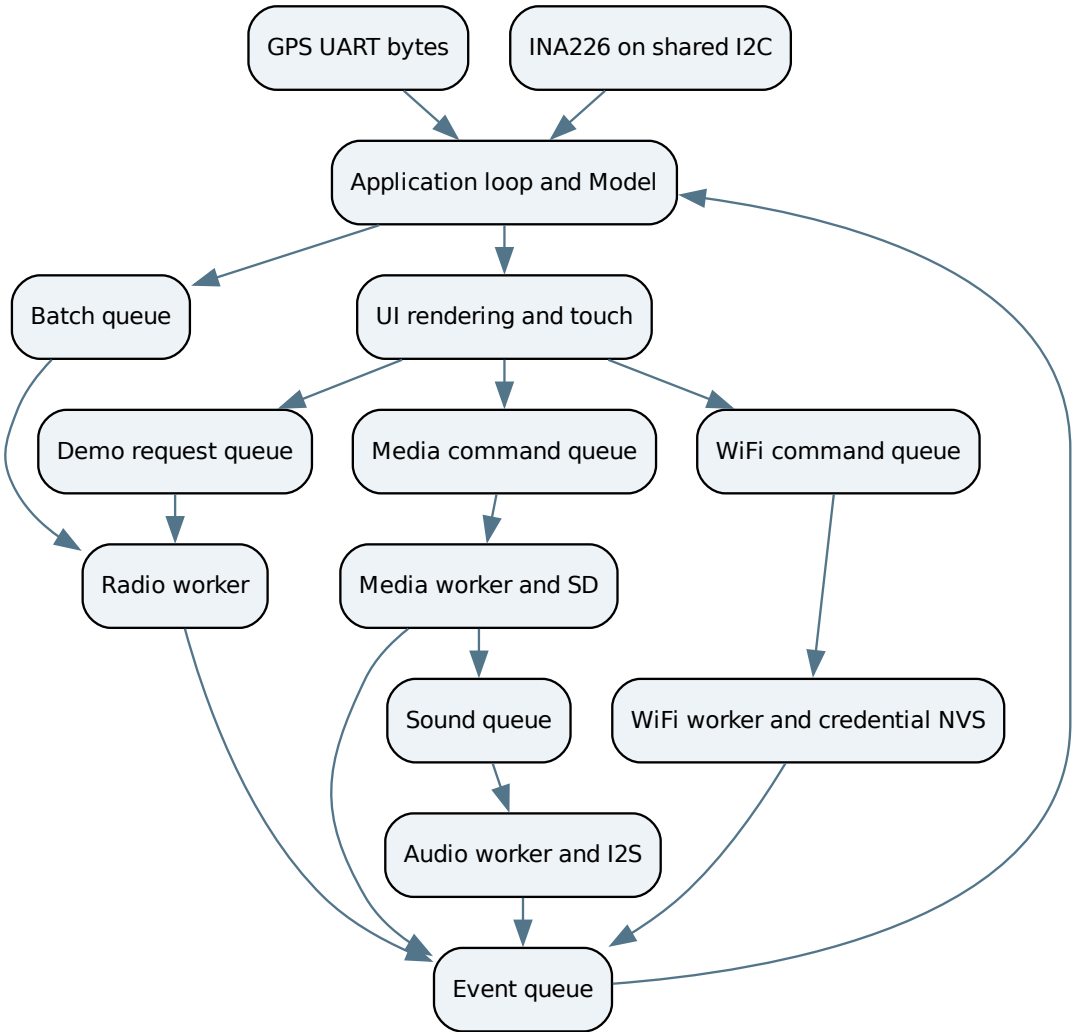


Figure 2: How measurements and requests move through the program

A button sends a request. The worker performs the slow operation. A later event updates the model. On its next refresh the UI presents the result. Queue acceptance and operation completion are separate moments.

For example, **Send demo** means that a demo request entered its one-item queue. The radio may still be joining or waiting for airtime. Only a later radio event can describe the send result. Even a local completed transmission does not prove that a gateway received the unconfirmed packet.

2.4 Who looks after each device

A worker is a background job. It can spend time connecting or reading a file while the main part of the program continues handling the screen. The priority and stack-size details below are for reference; leave them unchanged for the normal student project. A stack is memory a job uses while its functions run.

Context	Owns during normal operation	Baseline task configuration
Arduino application loop	Model, GPS parsing, sensor traffic, drawing, touch and shared live I2C	Core-managed `loopTask`
Radio worker	SX1262, its SPI bus, LoRaWAN state and `crow-lora` NVS	Priority 2; 12,288-byte stack
WiFi worker	Connection requests/status and `crow-wifi` credentials	Priority 1; 8,192-byte stack
Media worker	Slot-0 SD lifecycle, directory/file reads, JPEG decoding and sound-file loading	Priority 1; 24,576-byte stack
Audio worker	Playback I2S instance, amplifier playback control and sound-buffer disposal	Priority 2; 6,144-byte stack

The application's codec initialization is an explicit startup exception to live I2C ownership. After startup, do not add codec volume writes from the audio task: they would use the shared Wire bus outside its owner. A future runtime volume feature needs a deliberate owner-preserving interface.

A separate task does not guarantee responsiveness. Radio busy waits, priorities, rendering cost and shared SDK activity still matter. Runtime stack margins and latency have not been measured on the physical system. Adding a worker or increasing a priority is not a routine solution to a slow interface.

2.5 The Model holds what the screen needs

`Model` contains the latest `Reading`, GPS/status strings, acquisition minute, batch progress, lost-batch count and sensor/calibration status. `Application.cpp` owns its lifetime. `updateUi(Model&, bool)` stores a pointer to this same object; there is no independent UI measurement cache.

Workers do not write `model` directly. They send events. The application drains those events and changes the appropriate field. Keeping this boundary prevents a radio callback from modifying display objects while the UI is drawing.

The UI has its own private state for which screen is open, keyboard editing, touch-down detection and the displayed image buffer. These describe interaction, not a second version of the sensor or LoRaWAN state.

If your interface needs a value that can be computed from existing fields, derive it while rendering or in the application rule that needs it. For example, a low voltage caption does not need a second stored copy of the voltage. A latched alarm that remembers a past event does need state; assign that state to the application.

2.6 Requests waiting to be handled

A queue is a short waiting list inside the program. A button puts a request on that list, and a background job picks it up. Each list has a fixed capacity, so the program also needs a clear response when it is full. The names in the table below are the names you will find in the source code.

The queues are created in `startWorkers()` and their types are in `App.h` or locally in `Workers.cpp`.

Queue	Item and capacity	Producer → consumer	Meaning of a full queue
`events`	`Event`, 24 items	Workers → application	Worker sends block until space is available
`batches`	`Batch`, 6 items	Application → radio	The newly completed batch is dropped and `lostBatches` increases
`demoRequests`	One-byte request, 1 item	UI → radio	Another demo is already waiting
`mediaCommands`	`MediaCommand`, 4 items	UI → media	UI reports that the media queue is full
`wifiCommands`	`WifiCommand`, 1 item	UI → WiFi	`xQueueOverwrite` replaces an older pending request
`sounds`	Sound pointer/length, 1 item	Media → audio	The new buffer is freed and the media error is reported

The remaining details in this section are useful when you change background work or handle image and sound memory. For a first screen redesign, it is enough to know which existing command to send and how to show the result.

A `Batch` is copied into the queue. A `WifiCommand` contains fixed-size arrays and is copied too. `Event.text` is a fixed-size array. These values do not depend on a producer's temporary stack buffer after a successful send.

Image and sound items are different: the queue copies a **pointer**, not the data behind it. That requires a clear transfer of allocation ownership.

2.7 Who keeps and releases image and sound memory

For images, the media worker reads compressed bytes, decodes a 600×270 RGB565 canvas into PSRAM, frees the compressed input and queues an image event. When `presentImage()` receives it, it frees the previous canvas, adopts the new pointer and sets `event.pixels` to null. The application's subsequent `free(event.pixels)` is therefore harmless. If the display cannot accept the image, that application cleanup still releases the allocation.

For sound, the media worker allocates and loads PCM bytes. If queueing fails, it frees them. If queueing succeeds, the audio worker owns the buffer and frees it after playback or a reported failure. The currently playing sound is outside the queue; one additional buffer may be waiting.

When adding an image screen, use the existing retained image through the UI owner. Do not save another owning pointer and free both copies. When creating a different media flow, write down who allocates, who owns after each successful send, who handles send failure, and who eventually frees the data.

2.8 When readings happen, and what missing data means

`loopApplication()` regularly drains GPS input and worker events. Touch is polled at approximately 20 ms intervals; ordinary screen status refresh is about once per second. A forced redraw is used for screen transitions and image changes. The loop ends with a short 5 ms delay. These are scheduling intentions, not measured maximum response times.

Sampling uses `nextSample`, advancing by 60,000 ms per slot. It does not reschedule from the end of a slow conversion, which would accumulate drift. If deadlines are missed, old slots become invalid instead of pretending new readings were taken at those past times. The current slot can contain a real conversion. The conversion-ready wait is requested with a 60 ms timeout; I2C reads and other work add their own cost. This is not a measured whole-loop latency bound. Long work added here delays GPS, touch and event draining.

The default `Reading{}` contains NaN. That is an unavailable value, distinct from a real zero. The UI prints `--` for non-finite values. The version-1 encoder marks the whole triplet invalid if any of its values is unavailable or outside its range.

2.9 Four questions before you change something

Before changing a behavior, answer four questions:

1. Which owner has the original input and stored values?
2. Is this a UI choice, an application decision, a worker operation or a protocol change?
3. What result is visible before completion, on failure and after success?
4. Which existing test or user-visible check proves that behavior?

A layout change normally stays in `Ui.cpp`. A measurement interpretation belongs in the application. A file operation belongs in the media worker. A message-format change affects both encoder and decoder. This classification is more useful than adding a new task whenever a feature crosses a file boundary.

3. Your UI and application logic

You can replace the dashboard with your own design. Start with a small change that you can see, such as a label. Then decide what the readings mean for the person using your application. This section shows where to make those changes. The examples are for you to try; they are not already added to the template.

3.1 Start with a one-page application brief

Write down the intended user, the decision they need to make, the measurements that support that decision, and what your application does when data is missing. For a classroom DC supply monitor, a useful brief might be:

> A student should be able to see whether the test supply is within its expected range, inspect the most recent real measurement, and distinguish a low reading from a missing sensor. The application shows an advisory indication; it does not switch the physical load.

Specify the nominal test supply and the instructor-approved operating range. A number called “low voltage” has no meaning until the measured system is defined. List the screens and transitions, then sketch the layout at 1024×600. Decide where WiFi, media errors, GPS freshness, radio status and dropped batches remain visible.

3.2 Know which UI code to edit

`Ui.cpp` uses Arduino_GFX directly. It contains the display construction, colors, `Rect` hit testing, drawing helpers, private `Screen` state, `tap()` and polling. There is no widget tree or background UI framework to synchronize.

What you want to change	Existing place to inspect
Card positions, colors, text or labels	`updateUi()` and local drawing helpers
Image frame and media buttons	`drawImage()` and the corresponding `Rect` values
Dashboard/WiFi/downlink navigation	`Screen`, `tap()` and `updateUi()`
A screen's refresh behavior	Its branch in `updateUi()`
A button's behavior	Its hit-test branch in `tap()`
Touch hardware/orientation	`beginUi()`, `pollTouch()`, `readTouch()`; hardware-dependent

Keep display bus timing, panel initialization and pin settings separate from your visual design. Moving a card does not require changing the DSI constructor. The baseline requests 51 MHz and the pinned divider yields nominal 48 MHz; neither is a reason to tune timing to repair a layout mistake.

3.3 Worked example: an honest voltage caption

This example adds a caption to the existing voltage card. It does not take another sensor reading, send another packet or create an alarm task.

First, define the classroom threshold once in `Config.h`, outside `namespace Pins`:

```
// Classroom example for a specified 5 V DC supply; choose with your instructor.
constexpr float SupplyLowVoltage = 4.8f;
```

Then, inside `updateUi()`'s dashboard branch, replace the existing `labels` declaration with these declarations. Leave the existing values, units and drawing loop in place:

```
const char* voltageLabel = !std::isfinite(model.reading.voltage)
                               ? "VOLTAGE / NO DATA"
                              : (model.reading.voltage < SupplyLowVoltage ? "VOLTAGE / LOW" : "VOLTAGE");
const char* labels[] = {voltageLabel, "CURRENT", "POWER"};
```

This code goes into the existing dashboard drawing function. The card loop already draws `labels[n]` and `model.reading` values. A missing reading produces "NO DATA"; a real 0 V reading produces "LOW". The threshold does not claim that 4.8 V is suitable for every power system.

For this change, test NaN, 0 V, just below 4.8 V, exactly 4.8 V and above it. Check that captions fit within the card and do not leave old text on screen. The existing refresh clears the card before drawing, which handles a long-to-short label change.

If the low-voltage decision later drives batching, an acknowledged alarm or another application behavior, move the shared decision to the application owner. Do not repeat slightly different comparisons in the UI, network encoder and logger.

3.4 Build your own dashboard

A useful sequence is:

1. Keep the current model fields and draw them in your layout.

2. Move the matching hit rectangles with each visual control.
3. Test screen transitions and forced redraws.
4. Add application-specific presentation such as units, a range bar or an advisory caption.
5. Only then add new application state if the requirements need memory or new input.

`Rect::contains` includes the left/top edge and excludes the right/bottom edge. Use the same rectangle for drawing and hit testing where possible. Leave enough space between actions to avoid accidental activation. Test a held touch: the baseline triggers on the first down event, not continuously while held.

Keep drawing in the UI context. Use `model` passed to `updateUi()`; do not access `meter`, `gps`, `WiFi`, SX1262 or SD files from a drawing function. A renderer should finish promptly using already-available values.

When entering a new screen, the background and controls need a full draw. Periodic refresh should update the information that can change while that screen stays open. The existing downlink screen demonstrates this: a newly received message must appear without the user closing and reopening it.

If your layout removes the original dashboard footer, provide an equally clear place for sensor errors, calibration state, batch progress and drop counts. These are part of the meaning of the data, not optional decoration.

3.5 Put each decision in one place

Some decisions only need the latest reading: “Is the voltage low right now?” Others need to remember something: “Has the voltage been low since I last checked?” Decide which question you want to answer before adding variables. For example:

Requirement	Appropriate approach
Show whether the current voltage is below a limit	Derive from the latest valid reading
Keep a warning until the user acknowledges it	Application-owned state that remains set until cleared and an acknowledgement interface
Avoid changing warning state near a noisy threshold	One application-owned state machine with documented hysteresis
Display a historic minimum since boot	One application-owned accumulator updated once per valid sample
Save a user setting across reboot	A defined persistence owner, format and failure behavior

Do not infer a sample event from the one-second screen refresh: that would count the same one-minute reading repeatedly. A rule that processes each new measurement belongs at the sampling boundary in `Application.cpp`. Apply it to the real current slot only; a missed invalid slot must not become a real zero or a fabricated sample.

Write a small transition table before implementing a stateful feature. Include missing data, startup, a valid zero, recovery, acknowledgement and reboot. Decide whether state is recomputed or persisted. Avoid new flags when an enum can express the actual mutually exclusive states.

For an action handled by the application/UI loop itself, a short application function may be enough. It does not automatically need a new task and queue. If the action needs a worker-owned device, use or deliberately extend that worker’s command interface. Explain any new boundary before adding it.

3.6 Connect controls to existing commands

The existing Previous/Next/Play/Remount actions all use `mediaCommands`:

```
MediaCommand command = MediaCommand::Next;
bool queued = xQueueSend(mediaCommands, &command, 0) == pdTRUE;
if (!queued) {
    latest->media = "Media queue full / wait for current operation";
}
```

This fragment belongs inside a `Ui.cpp` action where `latest` is already valid. It illustrates the existing interface; do not add a second Next sender for the same tap. The `0` timeout keeps the UI from waiting for queue space. The worker's later event reports the operation result.

A new navigation button that only selects a screen changes UI state. It should not send a peripheral command just to trigger a redraw. Conversely, a Play button must not call `fopen()` or I2S writes directly.

For WiFi, retain the typed `WifiCommand` with its bounded arrays and one-item `xQueueOverwrite` behavior. Preserve password clearing, input validation and the worker's verified-save condition. Do not show a configuration as saved simply because a request was queued.

3.7 Receiving a message from the network

The baseline presents downlinks as escaped text with their application port. That is sufficient for a message viewer. It is not a typed control protocol. A nonprintable byte becomes a textual `\xNN` escape for display.

The same principle applies to GPS: `model.gps` is a formatted status string. If your rule needs numeric coordinates, expose typed values from the existing GPS owner rather than parsing display text or starting another UART parser.

If your application needs structured commands, first define a versioned payload, valid lengths, supported port, permitted values, result/error reporting and whether a repeated command is meaningful. Then define how the radio owner transfers the original payload to the application owner. Do not build a command parser by splitting `model.downlink`: it is formatted presentation text and may contain escapes. Such a feature changes an interface and requires coordinated tests; it is beyond a visual redesign exercise.

3.8 If you want to change the data being sent

An on-screen advisory derived from existing readings need not change the uplink. If you do change transmitted data, update `Telemetry.h`, `ttn-decoder.js`, the protocol description and reference/encoder/decoder tests as one change. Decide how old receivers recognize the new version. Recalculate the maximum size and pacing behavior at the slowest supported rate with pending MAC commands.

Do not change the sample period or add a transmission on every threshold crossing without analyzing acquisition meaning, queue capacity and airtime. A useful local feature can remain local while the existing radio policy sends measured data.

3.9 Review your change before moving on

Explain which file owns each new value and action. Check startup, missing input, queue full, stale data, screen reopening and recovery. Run the checks relevant to the changed

boundary. Keep a small diff and compare it with the baseline before adding the next feature. A student application should be understandable from its requirements and tests, not only from a successful demonstration.

4. Measurements, files and connections

A useful screen helps someone understand what is happening. To build one, you need to know what a measurement means and how recent it is. You also need to know whether a message is still waiting, has been sent, or has actually arrived. This section explains those differences and the files the template can use.

4.1 A zero reading is different from a missing reading

`Reading` has floating-point voltage, current and power. Its default constructor sets all three to NaN. Finite zero is meaningful: an unloaded circuit can have zero current. It must remain distinguishable from a missing or failed conversion.

The INA226 is configured and read by the application on the shared I2C bus. A scheduled acquisition checks connectivity, calibration-write status, completed conversion, register errors, math overflow and the calibrated/shunt range. Failed or saturated triplets become unavailable. A current at or above the configured calibration maximum is rejected; leave operating margin below that limit.

Shunt resistance is essential to current calibration. The voltage drop is roughly $I \times R$, and shunt heating is $I^2 \times R$. A chip's 36 V sense range does not rate the module's screw terminals or load circuit for a particular current. Inspect the actual board and use the wiring reference.

With `INA_SHUNT_OHMS=0`, local voltage can still be finite. Current and power remain unavailable, so the version-1 wire encoder marks the **entire triplet** invalid. Do not interpret an invalid TTN slot as proof that the bus voltage was zero.

The UI formats two decimal places. Those characters do not establish measurement accuracy. Shunt tolerance, calibration, ADC range and wiring all affect accuracy; the wire format also quantizes values.

4.2 Taking a reading and sending it happen at different times

The application creates one sample slot each minute from uptime minute 1. Ten slots form one `Batch`. A slot exists even if its measurement is invalid. `Batch.firstMinute` identifies the first slot, and indices 0–9 identify the rest.

A batch enters the six-item queue after its tenth slot. Once joined, the radio worker can hold an additional active batch while fragmenting or waiting. This is RAM buffering, not a durable log. If the queue is full, the new batch is dropped and the UI's cumulative dropped count increases. Reboot loses queued data.

At a slow data rate, delivery can fall behind acquisition. A received packet may therefore describe older measurements. Use the encoded uptime minute, not the server reception timestamp, to understand ordering. Uptime is not UTC; the baseline does not map GPS time into the telemetry protocol.

4.3 GPS status has two different questions

The GPS transmits NMEA over UART. `TinyGPSPlus::encode()` identifies a completed checksum-valid sentence. The application uses that to track recent valid input. A valid sentence may still report no location fix.

A location is displayed only when valid and younger than 10 seconds. Satellites have their own validity and age checks. The two main unavailable states are:

Status	Interpretation
No valid NMEA / check UART, baud	No recent checksum-valid sentence; investigate wiring, power or baud
No fresh fix / move antenna outdoors	Recent valid input exists, but a fresh usable position does not

The parser's permissive checksum helper has documented limits. This status is an operational aid, not a certification of arbitrary UART data. Do not keep a stale coordinate on your redesigned UI without visibly labelling it as stale.

4.4 Which image files to use

The media worker mounts the card at `/sdcard`. Files on the card use ordinary paths such as `/images/001.jpg`; application `fopen()` calls prepend the mount path. Up to 128 regular JPG/JPEG files are collected and sorted by filename. The first image is loaded after a successful mount, and Previous/Next wrap around the list.

Use baseline JPEG, at most 4 MiB compressed input. The decoder selects full, half, quarter or eighth scale for the 600×270 display canvas. A source that still does not fit after scaling is rejected. A 600×270 baseline image avoids scaling surprises; edge dimensions may hit the existing conservative scaling boundary.

The patched JPEGDEC rejects specified malformed SOF metadata and deliberately ignores EXIF interpretation. It does not apply EXIF orientation or expose extracted thumbnail metadata. Progressive JPEG is rejected by the application. Other decoder bounds remain known limitations, so use teacher-checked files for classroom bring-up. The patch is not a complete malformed-file validation system.

Retry SD requests a remount and directory rescan. An ordinary no-card failure can be retried; an unmount error latches storage unavailable until restart. SD and C6 Hosted share the controller, and runtime coexistence is unverified. Do not promise that every remount is independent of WiFi; a Hosted transport failure can reset the P4. Treat coexistence stress as an instructor-run hardware experiment.

4.5 Which sound files to use

The baseline accepts a specific, simple file layout:

- RIFF/WAVE with a canonical 44-byte header.
- PCM format 1, stereo, 16-bit little-endian samples, 48,000 Hz.
- A 16-byte `fmt` chunk immediately followed by `data` at the expected offsets.
- Positive PCM data length divisible by four, at most 4 MiB and within the file.

Stereo 16-bit audio uses four bytes per frame. At 48,000 frames per second, 4 MiB is about 21.8 seconds. MP3, AAC, extra WAV metadata chunks and other sample formats are outside the accepted baseline contract. A `.wav` extension alone is insufficient.

The repository overview provides an ffmpeg conversion example. Check the actual resulting header because tools can include additional chunks. Keep copyright and licensing information for resources you distribute to students.

The media worker loads the complete PCM buffer before queueing playback. The audio worker writes it to I2S and frees it afterward. GPIO30 is HIGH for amplifier shutdown and LOW while playing and draining. The ES8311 is mono; stereo input framing does not establish separate left/right audio channels at the speakers. Its driver also has retained false-success error paths, so setup success does not prove every codec register was written correctly.

4.6 WiFi and LoRaWAN serve different purposes

The P4 talks to its onboard C6 through ESP-Hosted SDIO to obtain WiFi. Compatible C6 slave firmware is required. WiFi can be configured from the touchscreen with SSID and Personal password, or an empty password for an open network. Enterprise and captive-portal flows are not implemented.

After an accepted request reaches an active WiFi connection, an IP address and the requested SSID, the WiFi worker saves one credentials blob in NVS. Queue acceptance, link association, IP acquisition and successful persistence are different steps. The UI reports failures rather than promising they all succeeded at Connect.

LoRaWAN uses the external SX1262 module and a gateway connected to a network server. Panel WiFi is not the LoRaWAN transport. A working access point connection does not establish a gateway path or a successful OTAA join.

4.7 TTN configuration and keys

Use the device registration assigned by the instructor: LoRaWAN MAC **1.1.0**, Regional Parameters **1.0.4**, EU868 frequency plan, OTAA and Class A. Configure `DEV_EUI`, `JOIN_EUI`, `APP_KEY` and `NWK_KEY` to match it. EUI macros are integer hex values in displayed order; root keys are 16-byte lists. Do not byte-reverse those example representations. No MQTT client ID or manually entered session keys are needed for the radio's OTAA activation.

Both 1.1 root keys are required. All-zero example keys or zero DevEUI keep radio operation disabled; negotiated 1.0 is rejected. `JOIN_EUI=0` is not inherently an error if it matches the assigned registration.

The radio stores nonce state and a boot ID in `crow-lora`. Before a join, it reserves the next DevNonce durably. An uncertain transmission cannot cause reuse of the old nonce. A storage/version failure stops RF. Reboot creates a fresh OTAA session rather than restoring uncertain uplink counters. Ordinary upload is not an instruction to erase nonce NVS. Coordinate credential/registration recovery with the instructor; do not repeatedly clear state to bypass a join failure.

4.8 Uplinks, downlinks and Class A

An **uplink** travels from the panel through a gateway to TTN. A **downlink** travels from TTN through a gateway to the panel. Class A opens receive windows after an uplink; it does

not listen continuously. A server-queued message therefore waits for a suitable next uplink and available network resources.

The template uses:

Application port	Direction/use
FPort 1	Binary measurement fragment uplink
FPort 2	Four-byte ASCII `DEM0` uplink
For example FPort 10	Instructor-chosen application downlink text

FPort 0 carries protocol MAC commands and is not an application-command port. The baseline displays the application port and printable text, escaping binary bytes as `\xNN`. A zero-length application message is labelled empty. A downlink screen left open refreshes when a new message arrives.

Paste the repository's `ttn-decoder.js` into the assigned TTN uplink formatter. The decoder is stateless: it decodes one fragment, not an entire stored device history. A local TX-completed event means the chip completed its operation; these uplinks are unconfirmed and gateway reception is not guaranteed.

4.9 A closer look at the message format

You can use the existing messages without changing how they are packed. This part is useful when you reach the message-decoding exercise or want to change the data being sent. A byte is eight bits; packing several values together keeps the radio message short.

A full ten-sample batch is $7 + 10 \times 4 = 47$ application bytes. Multi-byte fields are big-endian. The airtime/protocol specification is authoritative.

Byte offset	Size	Meaning
0	1	Version, currently 1
1	2	Boot ID
3	3	Batch's first sample uptime minute
6	1	High nibble: sample offset; low nibble: sample count
7 onward	4 per sample	Packed voltage/current/power or invalid sentinel

Each sample uses 11 voltage bits at 0.02 V, signed 11 current bits at 0.01 A, and 10 power bits at 0.1 W. `FFFFFFFF` represents an invalid triplet. Valid zero is `00000000`. Representable application ranges are 0–36 V, −10.23 to +10.23 A and 0–102.2 W; sensor calibration and hardware ratings can be much narrower.

At limited payload allowance the worker fragments without changing sample order. With 36 application bytes available, the first seven samples use 35 bytes and the remaining three use 19. The descriptor bytes are `0x07` and `0x73`. A backend can group fragments by device identity, boot ID and first sample minute, then deduplicate sample indices. Those identifiers wrap and are not globally permanent IDs.

4.10 Why messages may take longer than ten minutes to arrive

A batch becomes available every ten sample slots. It is not guaranteed to arrive at TTN every ten minutes. At slower spreading factors, sending all batches that frequently exceeds the configured public-network airtime allowance. The template keeps acquisition regular and slows transmission instead.

`PersistentNode` maintains one volatile deadline. It accounts for the aggregate predicted airtime of each completed join/send operation, including internal frames, then extends the deadline using the stricter applicable allowance. It does not reserve or gate every physical internal frame. Reboot clears the deadline; repeated resets can exceed allowances. This is a documented teaching trade-off.

Failed cold-boot joins start with a one-minute backoff base and progress toward DR0. Failure backoff eventually caps at 24 hours, with 0–60 s pseudo-random jitter added after the maximum existing hold. After a successful join, a later in-run session restart uses a 64-minute base and DR0. A replacement session also initially uses DR0 for data uplinks until network ADR changes it, so throughput can be much slower after that restart. Do not diagnose a paced queue as a frozen UI.

Use the airtime calculator and host tests for accelerated classroom reasoning. Public-network RF tests should follow the instructor's plan and current network rules. Changing a pacing macro to make a demo faster is a policy change with regional and network consequences.

5. Testing and troubleshooting

A useful test answers a specific question. Compiling checks whether your chosen code, libraries and settings can be built together. Tests on your computer can check message encoding or a timing decision. To check where a finger touches the screen, how the antenna switch behaves or what the speakers produce, you need the actual board.

5.1 Record a baseline and a small change

Before editing, record the source revision, local changes, board settings, dependency versions and selected paths. State the behavior you intend to change and the behavior that must remain. After editing, inspect the diff and run the checks for that boundary.

For a label/layout change, compilation, formatting and the relevant visual/touch checks are useful. For a changed encoder, run encoder/decoder/reference tests and recalculate sizes. For a changed background job, use its existing test with the actual application code and check both success and failure. A new check should assert the behavior, not merely compare two copies of the same calculation.

5.2 Host checks

The development host needs a C++17 compiler, Python 3, Node.js, `make`, `clang-format`, the standard `patch` command and the six exact isolated dependencies. The host C++ compiler is separate from the ESP32 target compiler used by Arduino.

From the repository root:

```
export DEPS=/absolute/path/to/dependencies
RADIOLIB_DIR="$DEPS/RadioLib" make -k format-check test \
  BUILD="$PWD/build/codex/student-tests"
```

`make -k` lets independent Make targets continue after another target fails. Inside `tools/test.py`, independent checks also continue and failures are reported together. A missing `RADIOLIB_DIR` is a failed prerequisite, not a passing skip. Its parent directory must contain the named sibling libraries used by the runners.

Check area	What it establishes	Important limit
Codec and JavaScript decoder	Packet/reference agreement, ranges, invalid sentinel and fragments	Not gateway delivery
Airtime reference	Formula and size/policy calculations	Not a measured RF waveform
Radio integration	Real patched RadioLib with extracted production node/worker logic	Simulated time/RF/NVS; host time types differ
INA226 acquisition	Real library with transport-level injected errors and production acquisition	Not real calibration accuracy
GPS status	Real parser plus extracted freshness logic	Not antenna reception or field probability of noise
JPEG admission	Real decoder test examples and sanitizer/bounds checks	Does not cover every possible invalid image or memory access
SD lifecycle	Slot accounting/failure behavior through a test that runs on the computer	Not Hosted concurrency or card electronics
WiFi form/worker	Validation, requests and persistence decisions	Not real C6 association/event timing
Amplifier/audio path	Extracted playback/GPIO ordering	Not actual speaker polarity, pops or audio quality

`make format` formats project-owned C++ files. Review what it changes, then use `make format-check`. Vendor sources are excluded. Some tests copy a marked section of the actual application code into a test program. If you reorganize that section, the test may need help finding it again. Keep testing the real code rather than replacing it with a separate version that only exists to make the test pass.

Target clang-tidy was attempted in the recorded baseline but the installed LLVM cannot process the ESP-specific GCC flags/target headers. That is a known analysis limit, not a clean static-analysis result. Do not weaken the configuration to turn the limitation into a reported pass.

5.3 Inspect a packet without TTN or RF

Run the matching decoder directly with Node.js:

```
node - <<'JS'
const fs = require('fs');
const {decodeUplink} = require('./ttn-decoder.js');
const bytes = JSON.parse(fs.readFileSync('tests/reference-packet.json', 'utf8'));
console.log(JSON.stringify(decodeUplink({fPort: 1, bytes}), null, 2));
JS
```

The test example includes ordinary values, invalid triplets and a valid zero. This lets you study data semantics without waiting ten minutes or sending a public-network packet. The values are a test example; do not present them as measured board data.

5.4 Observe the UI and asynchronous actions

For each control in your interface, write a short table containing:

- What the user requests.
- What appears immediately if queueing succeeds or fails.
- Which later event means completion.
- Which failures can arrive after queue acceptance.
- How the user can retry or recover.

Test screen reopening, a held touch, taps on edges and simultaneous status updates. For a derived warning, include missing data, valid zero, exact boundary and recovery. If the interface becomes slow, first remove long work from its render/touch path. A longer waiting list does not make the part doing the work any faster.

5.5 Start with what you can observe

Observation	Likely boundary to investigate	First useful check
Display init panic/reboot, no dashboard	DSI driver or board configuration	Read serial before worker startup; verify actual board/timing settings
Touch works until an I2C error, then stops	Intentional GT911 error latch	Repair shared bus, inspect levels/pull-ups, then restart
Voltage appears but current/power are `--`	Calibration configuration	Confirm actual shunt and `INA_SHUNT_OHMS`; inspect sensor status
All TTN triplets invalid despite local voltage	Version-1 all-three-values validity rule	Check calibration and finite current/power
First reading not yet visible	One-minute initial deadline	Check uptime and wait for slot 1
No valid NMEA	GPS UART/power/baud boundary	Verify module voltage/TXD and configured baud, inspect serial evidence
Valid input, no fresh fix	GPS position solution	Use appropriate antenna and sky view
SD ready but no images	Directory or scan	Check `/images`, extension, regular files and names
JPG failed	File read, size, baseline type, scale or decoder	Try a curated 600×270 baseline image
WAV/codec error	WAV contract, allocation or codec readiness	Check header/length and serial status; try curated short PCM
C6 unavailable	Hosted initialization/firmware	Compare host/slave logs; restart after resolving setup
Connection request failed	STA request rejected	Check SSID/password and actual connection state; do not infer saved credentials
Radio asks to fill credentials	Deliberate blank configuration gate	Check assigned EUIs and both root keys locally

Observation	Likely boundary to investigate	First useful check
Radio init failed	SPI, BUSY/reset, supply, TCXO or RF-switch setup	Inspect wiring and serial return code before testing RF
Joined but demo stays queued	Airtime hold or current batch	Inspect radio status, active work and configured policy
Batch queue grows at slow data rate	Acquisition exceeds delivery capacity	Use airtime calculation; preserve drop visibility
New downlink does not arrive immediately	Class-A receive opportunity/network path	Check next permitted uplink and server queue, within test plan
SD action resets the panel	Shared SDMMC/Hosted risk	Stop the stress sequence; capture reset/Hosted logs with instructor

A symptom can have several causes. Change one justified variable, repeat the relevant check, and keep the evidence. A generic library update, flash erase or pin reassignment removes the baseline you are trying to diagnose.

5.6 Hardware acceptance and retained limits

The hardware checklist is the complete reference. For a student project, the instructor should identify which physical checks have already been performed on the supplied kit and which are still open.

Retained limits include shared SD/Hosted lifecycle behavior, possible whole-P4 restart on Hosted failure, ES8311 false-success paths, nested MAC recursion, unmeasured stack/latency margins and incomplete malformed-JPEG coverage. The radio also has documented network-side edge cases. Use teacher-checked files on the SD card and the assigned network setup; a host PASS does not close these items.

Test antenna/power/TCXO/RF-switch behavior, GPS levels, sensor shunt, display/touch orientation and real audio separately. Do not apply mains or an unspecified high current to a teaching breakout. The public-network airtime/deployment conditions remain in force even when the software is a classroom template.

5.7 What to submit with an application

Provide your application brief, screen map, screenshots labelled as mockup or actual hardware capture, a short ownership/data-flow explanation, a clean configuration example without secrets, dependency/build settings and relevant test evidence. Explain any protocol change with both encoder and decoder updates. Include known limitations and exactly which physical checks were performed. Keep host simulation, compile success and device operation as separate evidence categories.

Glossary

Term	Meaning in this template
Application rule	A decision derived from data, such as whether a valid supply reading is below the experiment’s threshold.
Owner	The part of the program responsible for a device or stored value. Other parts ask it to do work.
Model	The latest readings and status messages that the screen uses.

Term	Meaning in this template
Task / worker	A background job, such as handling the radio or reading files, that runs alongside the main Arduino loop.
Queue	A waiting list of requests or results. It has a fixed amount of space.
Backpressure	What happens when requests arrive faster than they can be handled: the waiting list grows or becomes full.
Event	A result or status message sent back by a background job.
PSRAM	External RAM used for large image/audio allocations; it is not persistent storage.
NVS	Settings kept in flash memory across restarts, including WiFi credentials and radio join counters.
I2C	Shared two-wire bus used here by sensor, touch controller and codec.
SPI	Clocked serial interface used for the external LoRa radio.
UART / NMEA	Serial transport / sentence format used by the GPS receiver.
I2S / PCM	Audio transport / numerical audio sample representation.
DMA	Hardware transfer support that can leave a short audio tail after the last application write.
NaN	Floating-point “not a number,” used to represent unavailable readings.
Quantization	Representing a measurement in fixed increments, such as 0.02 V per transmitted step.
LoRa	The radio modulation used by the SX1262.
LoRaWAN	The network protocol managing activation, counters, MAC commands and receive windows.
OTAA	The join process that uses your assigned device identity and keys to establish a network session.
DevNonce	A number used when joining LoRaWAN. The template saves it so a restart does not cause it to be reused.
Uplink / downlink	Device-to-network / network-to-device message direction.
Class A	Receive windows following an uplink, rather than continuous listening.
FPort	A number describing what a LoRaWAN message is for. Port 0 is reserved for network-control messages.
ADR / DR / SF	Adaptive Data Rate / data-rate index / spreading factor. A slower rate usually needs more airtime.
MAC command / FOpts	Network-control command / header field that can carry MAC commands and reduce application allowance.
RekeyInd / RekeyConf	LoRaWAN 1.1 session key confirmation exchange relevant to the in-run session-restart path.
Airtime	Time occupied by an actual or predicted radio frame on the channel.
Jitter	A varying extra retry delay that helps avoid synchronized retries.
Fragment	Part of one batch, carrying an offset/count so sample order is preserved.
ESP-Hosted	The transport/software arrangement through which the P4 uses the separate C6 WiFi device.

Term	Meaning in this template
FQBN	Arduino’s board identifier plus selected build options.
Host test	A check running on the development computer with an explicit harness, separate from target firmware operation.